

# The Pulse

\$2,500 A YEAR

One question, every Tuesday, three seconds to answer. Across a school year it builds a live picture of how your staff are doing across Mood, Energy, Belonging, Purpose and Needs. Once a month it asks what went well and what did not, and once a month it tells you what to do about it. No survey day, no staff meeting, nothing to run after setup.

WHAT YOUR STAFF GET

TUESDAY CHECK · WEEK 14 OF 40

Which face matches today?

Thriving

**Good**

Okay

Tough

Rough

One tap. Nothing else asked of you.

Coffee's on us.

You're this week's random pick. See Ms. Alvarez to collect.

Tell me more (optional)

Not monitored in real time. If something needs attention today, tell someone at your school.

Every staff member, not only teachers. Paras, coaches, office and support staff all answer the same question.

WHAT YOU SEE

Lincoln Middle School · week 14 · 87% responding

Mood

4.1

Energy

6.8

Belonging

5.2

Purpose

7.4

Teal bar is your school. Gold line is the benchmark.

Needs

Not a score. What your staff asked for this month.

Rest 34%

Less on plate 22%

Clarity 18%

Recognition 12%

Mood, week by week

| Month | School Mood | Benchmark |
|-------|-------------|-----------|
| AUG   | 4.5         | 4.0       |
| OCT   | 3.8         | 4.0       |
| DEC   | 4.2         | 4.0       |
| FEB   | 3.5         | 4.0       |
| APR   | 4.3         | 4.0       |

The late-October dip and the February slide are what a quarterly survey averages away.

HOW IT RUNS

Nothing to set up

One onboarding form, no kickoff call. Delivery starts the following Tuesday. Fall and spring data calls are booked at signing, and that is your whole time commitment.

Delivered by email

Staff can opt in to receive it by text instead. No app, no login, no account. Forty Tuesdays, with two summer months turned off to match your calendar.

Nothing to interpret

Everything lands on the leadership dashboard automatically, plus a monthly report with one suggested move and newsletter copy written from your own data.

Objectives

- I can see where my staff are struggling, and whether it is sliding week to week
- I can find out what they are actually asking for, ranked
- I can know whether my numbers are normal for a school like mine
- I can be told what to do next, not handed a dashboard to interpret

# Once a month, it goes deeper

The last Tuesday of each month replaces the usual question with two: what went well, and what did not. Same ten options both ways, which is the part that makes it useful.

## WHAT YOUR STAFF GET

LAST TUESDAY · NOVEMBER

What was a win this month?

Working with my colleagues

Student behavior

Feeling appreciated

Ten options. Same list for both questions.

And what was a struggle?

Student behavior

My workload

Having enough time

Tell me more (optional)

Two taps, about six seconds. Nine times a year.

Win first, always. A struggle-only question turns into a monthly complaint log, and leaders stop opening those by February.

## WHAT YOU SEE

Student behavior, both ways

The same item can be a win for some of your staff and a struggle for others.

NAMED IT A WIN

Behavior 22%

Colleagues 47%

Time 9%

NAMED IT A STRUGGLE

Behavior 41%

Workload 36%

Time 33%

Behavior is a win for 22% and a struggle for 41%. Somebody in your building has already found something that works.

## AND THE MONTH'S ONE MOVE

Monthly leader report · November · Lincoln Middle School

Mood dropped, and rest is the ask

Mood fell from 5.4 to 4.1 across November, concentrated in 6th through 8th rather than across the building. The top request was rest, up from third in October.

Suggested move. Give fifteen minutes of your December staff meeting back. Cancel the agenda for that block and say why out loud. Rest was the ask, and the fastest version of it you control is time you already own.

What this can't tell you: whether the dip is workload or something specific to that grade band. Three weeks of data is not enough to be sure.

One move, not a menu. Two alternates sit underneath it. Nothing that needs budget, a hire, or a new initiative.

## THE TEN OPTIONS, USED FOR BOTH QUESTIONS

Student behavior

My workload

Having enough time

Support from leadership

Working with my colleagues

Knowing what's going on

Feeling appreciated

Families and parents

My own energy

A specific student or group

Nothing stands out this month

Seeded from what staff across TDI schools already tell us, reviewed once a year, and fixed within a school year so the trend holds. "Nothing stands out" is a real answer, not a dodge.

What the monthly question protects

- Individual answers are never shown to anyone at your school
- Written comments are reported as themes, never quoted
- The same item ranked a struggle three months running is named as a focus area
- Nobody is ever identified as having skipped or named anything

# Twenty questions, five ways of asking

Four questions per dimension, rotating so nobody sees the same one twice. Every one is a tap: a face, a word, a colour, or one of two.

## MOOD · PICK A FACE

**Which face matches today?**

Thriving · Good · Okay · Tough · Rough

## MOOD · CHOOSE UP TO THREE

**Pick words that describe today.**

Energized · Overwhelmed · Grateful · Burned out · Steady · Anxious · Hopeful · Drained

## ENERGY · ONE OF TWO

**Right now I feel more...**

In the flow / Uphill battle

## BELONGING · FINISH THE SENTENCE

**At school today I feel \_\_\_\_ .**

like I belong · appreciated · like a cog · like a stranger

## PURPOSE · COLOUR SCALE

**How connected do you feel to your why?**

Very · Mostly · Some · Barely · Not at all

## NEEDS · FINISH THE SENTENCE

**Today I could use more \_\_\_\_ .**

support · time · encouragement · quiet · energy · celebration

## WHAT LANDS AFTER THE TAP

**Coffee's on us.**

A real prize, drawn at random, collected from your principal. Rare enough to stay interesting. You set the budget at signing, or skip it entirely.

**61% of your building said the same thing.**

Proof it went somewhere. The strongest one, and it costs nothing.

**Press this button.**

A cat photo, a school-appropriate knock-knock joke, a round of applause with a counter, or a small fact. One press, then get on with your day.

**That's fourteen in a row.**

Noticed, never enforced. Missed weeks never mentioned. Non-responders stay invisible to the leader.

**A line worth reading.**

Not a lesson, and never a note about attitude for someone who just said their week was rough.

**Sometimes nothing at all.**

Unpredictable beats consistent. If they know what Tuesday brings, they stop caring by week four.

## EVERY REWARD PASSES THE SAME TEST

**Fine in the hallway**

Nothing religious, political, discriminatory, crude, or adult. If it needs context or a closed door, it does not ship.

**Works for every role**

Nothing that assumes a classroom. A joke about lesson plans excludes the custodian, the bus driver and the office manager.

**Never at their expense**

No jokes about being tired, underpaid, or counting down to Friday. Staff are allowed to say it. We are not.

*All figures shown are examples.*

## However you start, you have the proof before the budget conversation

Early March: one page, where you started against where you are, formatted to forward

In hand before April and May budget talks, not during them

June: the full year, what changed, and what carries forward

Contracts run January to December or August to July, two summer months off